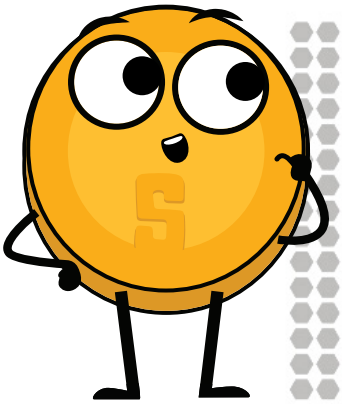
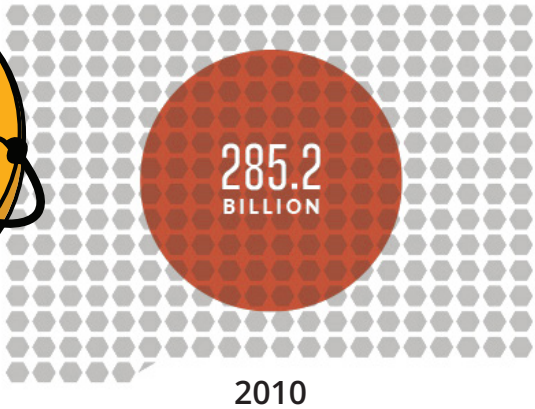
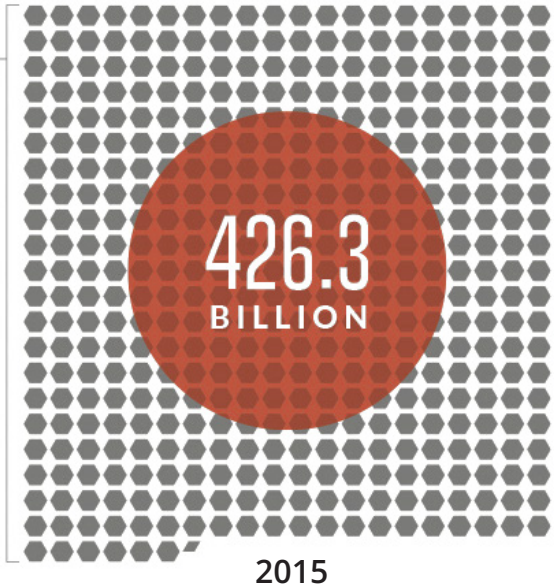
By 2015, there were 426 billion cashless transactions worldwide - a 50% increase from five years before.



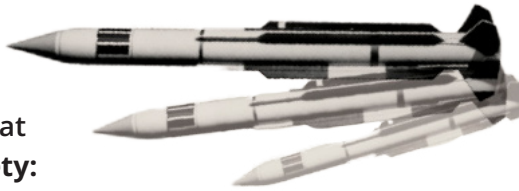


2010



2015

The First Shots Fired



The success of these new technologies has prompted lawmakers to posit that all transaction should be now digital. **Here is their case for a cashless society:**

Removing high denominations of bills from circulation makes it harder for terrorists, drug dealers, money launderers, and tax evaders.

1

- $1 million in $100 bills weighs only ten kilograms (22lbs).
- Criminals move $2 trillion per year around the world each year.
- The U.S. $100 bill is the most popular note in the world, with 10 billion of them in circulation.

2

- Money that is traceable means higher tax revenues.
- It also means there is a third-party involved with all transactions.
- Central banks can dictate interest rates that encourage (or discourage) spending to try to manage inflation. This includes ZIRP or NIRP policies.

This gives regulators more control over the economy.

Cashless transactions are faster and more efficient.

3

- Banks would incur less costs by not having to handle cash.
- It also makes compliance and reporting easier.
- The "burden" of cash can be up to 1.5% of GDP, according to some experts.